trade, tariffs, and duties.[20] At the same time, while market access for traded goods is central to the RCEP, India's concern has been access for services, given their central role in the Indian economy. Furthermore, concerns have been voiced over the fact that 65 percent of India's goods trade deficit in 2017–18 was with RCEP countries, indicating that removal of customs duties could flood India with cheap foreign goods, with consequences for Indian businesses. In early 2019, the Modi government sought more facts and views, commissioning several studies of the RCEP's consequences for the Indian economy from independent think tanks.[21] In November 2019, India finally decided to pull out of the RCEP, quoting concerns about getting swamped by imports, thus putting its domestic industry and agriculture at risk.[22] Other main reasons for India's decision appear to be concerns over access to the RCEP markets for India's services sector, the potential for being flooded with cheap Chinese goods, and India's large trade deficit with China.[23] China has been a keen supporter of the RCEP, and even more so lately because of China's trade frictions with the United States.

Over the course of 2018 and 2019, the Indian government also discussed the best approach to handle the Chinese telecom company Huawei. The United States asserts that it is keeping Huawei out of the American market for security reasons, and it is running a campaign to convince European allies to boycott Huawei. In summer 2019, India was reportedly seeking ways to limit Huawei Technologies' involvement in India's 5G infrastructure – preferably without visibly singling out the company. A "middle approach," which could be contemplated was to exclude Huawei from 5G projects in border areas affected by territorial disputes.[24] Speaking in New Delhi in October 2019, US Commerce Secretary Wilbur Ross expressed hopes that "our geopolitical partner India does not inadvertently subject